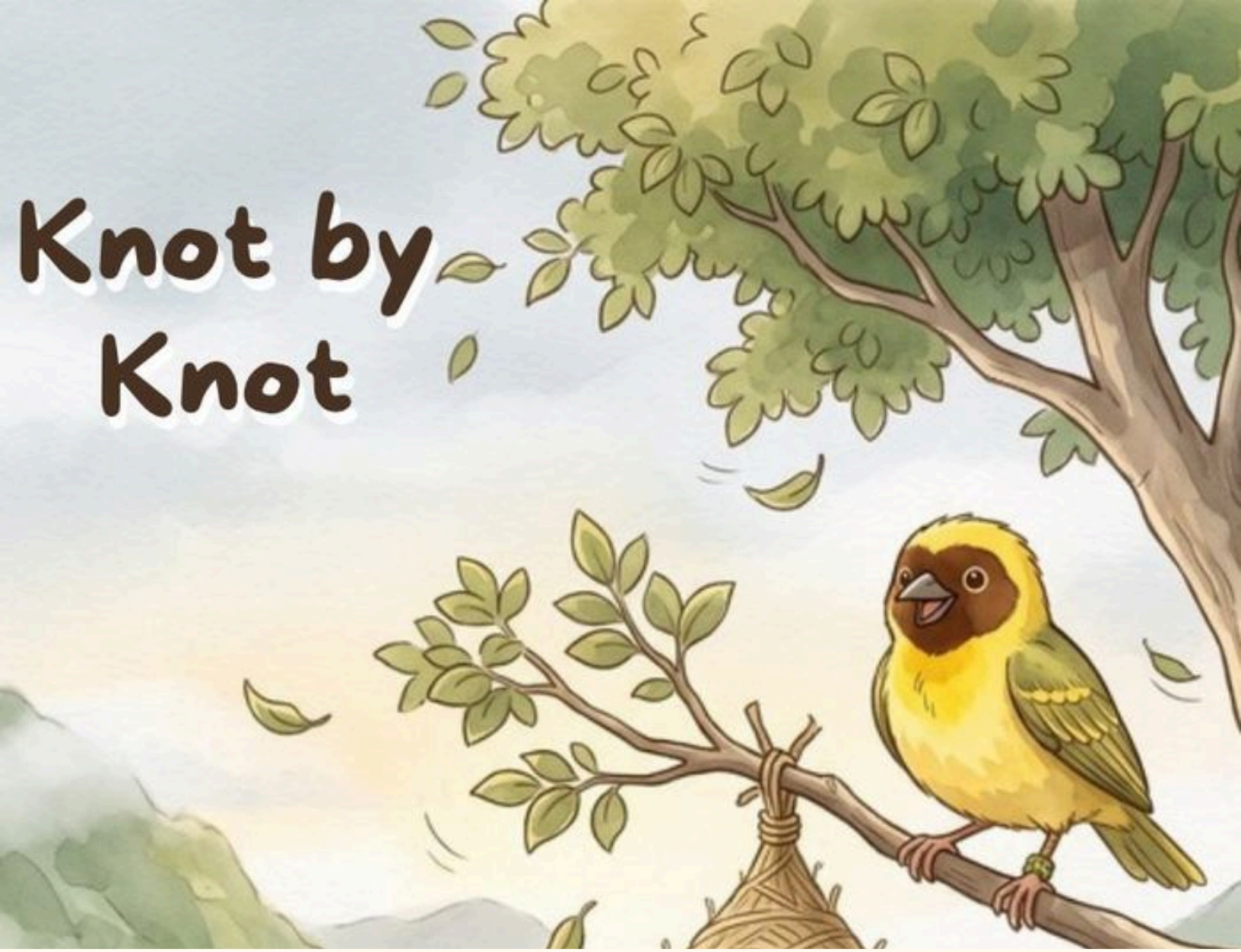


Classroom SEL pack, a week on doing it well, ages 3 to 7

Knot by Knot

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 Paper weaving	Children weave strips over and under, saying ‘loop, pull, tug’ as they go. Stop together after ten minutes and ask: Is it strong? Is it finished? Then finish it. Display …	Page 8
Day 5 Done or done well?	Done or done well?, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Self-Regulation and Well-Being, Problem Solving and Innovating, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours, Belonging and Contributing

Materials

The book (or the class screen), strips of paper or ribbon, a paper plate or card with slits, a sand timer

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English, French, Spanish, German, Italian.

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Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: What is the little bird making? How do you think it does that with only a beak? Ask: Have you ever rushed to finish something? Have you ever kept fixing something over and over? Take a few answers. Teach the refrain with a hand motion: loop (circle a finger), pull (pull your hand back), tug (a small jerk). Say ‘Loop, pull, tug!’ together.

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
2	Zayn is always finished first: Zip, zip, done!	Is being first always the best?	not always, sometimes you make mistakes
3	Hana asks: ‘Is it done, or done well?’	What is the difference between done and done well?	done well means it is strong, careful, it works
5	The nest falls into the pool.	Why did the nest fall?	he rushed, the knots were not tight Go further: How does Zayn feel now?
6	Zayn watches Hana: grip, test, step.	What does Zayn learn from watching Hana?	go slowly, check, be careful
7	Zayn keeps untying crooked knots.	Is this a good idea? Why or why not?	no, he will never finish; yes, he wants it strong Go further: Who is waiting for him?
8	Rima shivers; the clouds roll in.	How is Rima feeling?	cold, worried, tired of waiting
9	Hana: ‘If I waited for a perfect branch, I’d never get anywhere.’	What does Hana mean?	nothing is perfect, you have to keep going
11	The wind blows all night; every knot holds.	Was the nest perfect? Did it work?	no, it had crooked knots; yes, it held

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don’t need every stop.

Handle with care: Some children feel big worry about mistakes. Keep the message gentle: crooked knots are fine, and finishing is something to be proud of. More notes on the “For every child” page.

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Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

weave

to cross strips over and under to make something

Do it: wiggle one hand through the fingers of the other

knot

a tight twist that holds string or grass together

Do it: make two fists and pull them apart

sag

to droop down in the middle

Do it: let your arms flop down

crooked

not straight, a bit bent

Do it: bend your finger sideways

finish

to get to the very end

Do it: brush your hands together: done!

Loop, pull, tug!

Say it together whenever it comes up in the story.

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Do it well, and get it done.

Loop, pull, tug!

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How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



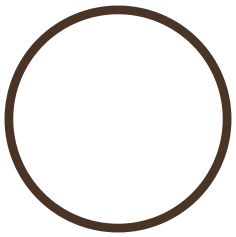
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



something else

clip your name here

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Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

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Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

Paper weaving

20 minutes, Individual, Materials: Card with slits, paper strips

Children weave strips over and under, saying ‘loop, pull, tug’ as they go. Stop together after ten minutes and ask: Is it strong? Is it finished? Then finish it. Display the mats ‘crooked bits and all’.

Done or done well?

10 minutes, Small groups, Materials: Blocks, a sand timer

Build a tower as fast as possible, then gently test it by blowing on it. Build again slowly and test. Then build a third time with the timer: careful, and finished before the sand runs out.

Grip, test, step

5 minutes, Whole class, Materials: A tape line on the floor

Walk the line like Hana: grip with your toes, test, step. Then walk it like Zayn at the start. Talk about which way worked better.

Science and nature corner

Rüppell’s weavers live in north-east Africa and south-west Arabia, including the mountains of Dhofar in Oman. The males weave round hanging nests from strips of grass using their beaks and feet. Scientists have found that weaver birds get better at weaving with practice. Arabian chameleons move slowly, gripping branches with their feet and tail, and can move each eye on its own.

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Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. What happened to Zayn's first nest? Why?

Look for: It sagged and fell in the pool because he rushed.

2. How did weaving slowly feel to Zayn?

Look for: Different, nice, like humming a song.

3. Why did he keep untying his knots?

Look for: He wanted them to be perfect.

4. What helped him finish?

Look for: Hana's words, Rima waiting, seeing his nest was already good.

5. What is something you can do well and finish this week?

Look for: Any answer. Write them on a 'done well' chart.



Say it together

Loop, pull, tug!

The big idea: Do your work with care, and then finish it. Rushing makes weak work, and waiting for perfect means it never gets done.

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Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show doing it well this week. Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show doing it well by

Name _____



I can show doing it well by

Name _____



I can show doing it well by

Name _____



I can show doing it well by

Name _____

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What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Problem Solving and Innovating	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Belonging and Contributing	Notes

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Science and place corner

Zayn's hill is in Dhofar, in the south of Oman. Every summer from late June to late September, the khareef brings drizzle and fog, and the dry hills turn bright green.



Rüppell's weaver

Scientists filmed weaver birds building nest after nest. The more nests a bird built, the fewer blades of grass it dropped. Building is a skill they learn, just like Zayn!



Arabian chameleon

A chameleon's eyes swivel separately: one can look up and left while the other looks down and right. When she spots a bug, both eyes lock on it.



Weaver chick

About two weeks in the egg, then about 18 days in the nest, and the chick is ready to leave home. Less than five weeks in all!

Dhofar, southern Oman, in the khareef

Zayn: Real weavers really do get better with practice. But a real male weaver builds his nest to win a mate, not for his little sister. And the green grass ring on Zayn's leg is our artist's idea.

Hana: Real Arabian chameleons really are slow and careful, and really are green in the khareef. The pale blue stripe along Hana's side is our artist's touch, so you can always find her.

Rima: In real life, a chick is cared for by its parents, not by a big brother, and it would be flying by itself at about 18 days old. The brown feather cap on Rima's head is just for the story.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/knot-by-knot

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For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first. The refrain has three short action words with gestures, so every child can join in. Use real string to show knot, loop and tug.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 5, 7 and 11). Offer wider paper strips and fewer slits for the weaving.

Children who are perfectionists

Praise finishing out loud. Set a gentle time limit and celebrate the ‘crooked knots and all’ result. Avoid naming any child as ‘too slow’.

Handle with care

Some children feel big worry about mistakes. Keep the message gentle: crooked knots are fine, and finishing is something to be proud of.

Never shame speed or slowness. Both Zayn and the children are learning a balance.

The storm in the story is safe: Zayn and Rima are always on the branch or in the nest. Keep the wind talk calm.

Where this value comes from

In Arabic there is a word, itqan, for doing your work with care, all the way to the end. You can see it in the crafts of the region, like Omani palm-leaf weaving, made strand by strand until it is finished and ready to use.

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Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read Knot by Knot, a story about doing things well and getting them done. Zayn the weaver bird learns that rushing makes a weak nest, and waiting for perfect means it never gets finished. At home, choose one small job with your child, like tidying a shelf, and help them do it with care and finish it. You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu Nœud par nœud, une histoire sur le travail bien fait et mené jusqu'au bout. Zayn le tisserin apprend que se dépêcher donne un nid fragile, et qu'attendre la perfection empêche de finir. À la maison, choisissez une petite tâche avec votre enfant, comme ranger une étagère, et aidez-le à la faire avec soin jusqu'au bout. Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre hacer las cosas bien y terminarlas. Zayn, un pajarito tejedor, aprende que con prisa el nido queda débil, y que si espera a que todo sea perfecto nunca lo termina. En casa, elijan una tarea pequeña, como ordenar un estante, y ayude a su hijo o hija a hacerla con cuidado hasta el final. Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

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Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte darüber gelesen, Dinge gut zu machen und fertig zu machen. Der Webervogel Zayn lernt, dass ein eiliges Nest schwach ist und dass man nie fertig wird, wenn man auf Perfektion wartet. Wählen Sie zu Hause mit Ihrem Kind eine kleine Aufgabe, etwa ein Regal aufräumen, und helfen Sie ihm, sie sorgfältig zu Ende zu bringen. Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia sul fare le cose bene e portarle a termine. Zayn, un piccolo uccello tessitore, impara che la fretta fa un nido debole e che aspettare la perfezione impedisce di finire. A casa, scegliete insieme un piccolo compito, come riordinare uno scaffale, e aiutate vostro figlio o vostra figlia a farlo con cura fino alla fine. Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

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Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Doing it well: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Doing it well: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Doing it well: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

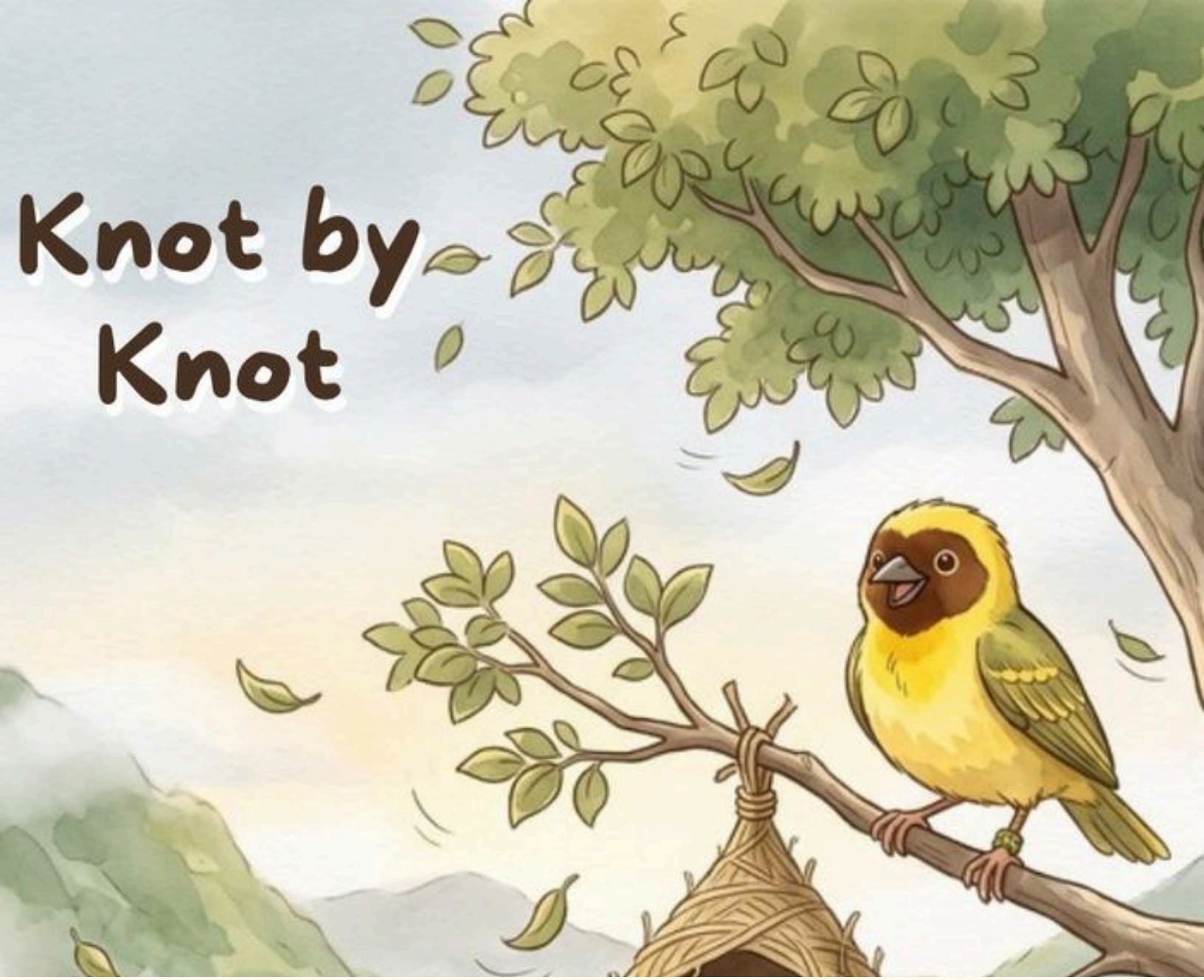
Doing it well: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

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Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

Knot by Knot

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: doing it well.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Do your work with care, and then finish it. Rushing makes weak work, and waiting for perfect means it never gets done.

Say it together

Loop, pull, tug!

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
weave	to cross strips over and under to make something	wiggle one hand through the fingers of the other
knot	a tight twist that holds string or grass together	make two fists and pull them apart
sag	to droop down in the middle	let your arms flop down
crooked	not straight, a bit bent	bend your finger sideways
finish	to get to the very end	brush your hands together: done!

A gentle note

Some children feel big worry about mistakes. Keep the message gentle: crooked knots are fine, and finishing is something to be proud of.

Never shame speed or slowness. Both Zayn and the children are learning a balance.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Zayn

Rüppell's weaver

The fastest beak in the colony, learning to build well



Hana

Arabian chameleon

The careful friend: grip, test, step



Rima

Weaver chick

Zayn's little sister, who needs a snug nest

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How did they feel?

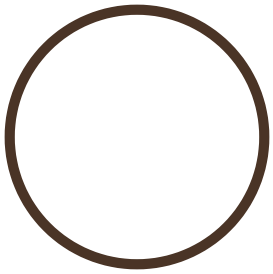
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Zayn is always finished first: Zip, zip, done!

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

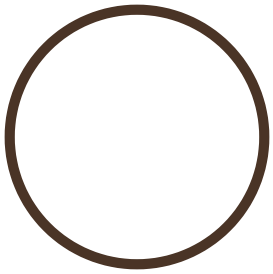


Moment 2

Zayn keeps untying crooked knots.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

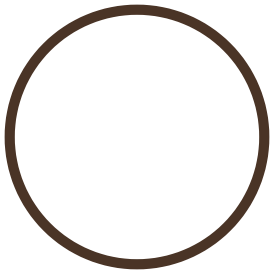


Moment 3

The wind blows all night; every knot holds.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

weave to cross strips over and under to make something

weave weave

knot a tight twist that holds string or grass together

knot knot

sag to droop down in the middle

sag sag

Zayn the hero of the story

Zayn Zayn

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Zayn showed doing it well. Draw a time when you showed doing it well too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Paper weaving

You need: Card with slits, paper strips

Children weave strips over and under, saying ‘loop, pull, tug’ as they go. Stop together after ten minutes and ask: Is it strong? Is it finished? Then finish it. Display the mats ‘crooked bits and all’.

Loop, pull, tug

Weave strips of paper or wool through a fork or a paper plate. Is your second try neater than your first?

Grip, test, step

Walk along a line on the floor like Hana: grip, test, step. Slow and careful, all the way to the end.

Chameleon eyes

Cover one eye and look around, then the other. A chameleon can use each eye separately all the time!

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in Knot by Knot are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Zayn

Rüppell's weaver

Scientists filmed weaver birds building nest after nest. The more nests a bird built, the fewer blades of grass it dropped. Building is a skill they learn, just like Zayn!



Hana

Arabian chameleon

A chameleon's eyes swivel separately: one can look up and left while the other looks down and right. When she spots a bug, both eyes lock on it.



Rima

Weaver chick

About two weeks in the egg, then about 18 days in the nest, and the chick is ready to leave home. Less than five weeks in all!

Story or real?

Real weavers really do get better with practice. But a real male weaver builds his nest to win a mate, not for his little sister. And the green grass ring on Zayn's leg is our artist's idea.

Where they really live

Zayn's hill is in Dhofar, in the south of Oman. Every summer from late June to late September, the khareef brings drizzle and fog, and the dry hills turn bright green.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/knot-by-knot

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What is the little bird making? How do you think it does that with only a beak?

Knot by Knot, talk card 1

What happened to Zayn's first nest? Why?

Knot by Knot, talk card 2

How did weaving slowly feel to Zayn?

Knot by Knot, talk card 3

Why did he keep untying his knots?

Knot by Knot, talk card 4

What helped him finish?

Knot by Knot, talk card 5

What is something you can do well and finish this week?

Knot by Knot, talk card 6

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Doing it well hero

This is to say that

_____

showed doing it well, just like Zayn.

Loop, pull, tug!

Signed _____ Date _____

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